

How to Run Your Books

SPENDING TRACKED. BUSINESS GROWN. · Private pilot · V2.4

Capture Tracker tells you what needs attention and takes you to the protected workflow that resolves it. You do not need to learn the navigation before keeping the S-Corp's books current.

First setup

Follow the visible roadmap:

1. Confirm the business.
2. Add the business bank or credit-card account.
3. Tell Capture Tracker where the books start.
4. Confirm applicable owner and payroll context.
5. Import and review the first activity.
6. Complete the initial exact reconciliation.
7. Begin the normal routine.

Use approved source facts. Unknown or uncertain opening facts remain **UNKNOWN**, **NEEDS REVIEW**, or **CPA REVIEW** rather than becoming invented accounting history.

As things happen

Use **+ New** or Today's four frequent actions:

- Create invoice
- Add bill
- Add receipt
- Record mileage

Owner-paid expenses, owner transfers, and transaction imports remain grouped in **+ New** without competing on Today.

Once a week

Open **Today -> Run My Books**.

Capture Tracker assembles only relevant owner-action sections: transactions, receipts and documents, money coming in, money going out, Owner Money, payroll, reconciliation, and occasional periodic review. Irrelevant sections are skipped. Resolve each linked exception, return to the routine, and finish when the screen shows the current-through state.

Completing Run My Books records acknowledgement. It does not post transactions, hide unresolved records, or change accounting history.

Once a month

Open the month-end prompt or **More -> Monthly routine -> Reconciliation**:

1. Review activity.
2. Resolve documents.
3. Reconcile business accounts.
4. Resolve Owner Money and payroll exceptions.
5. Review remaining blockers.
6. Close the month with explicit owner confirmation.

Closing locks the period. Corrections use controlled reversal or adjustment workflows; history is never deleted.

During the year

Use **More -> Owner & S-Corp** for occasional payroll context, estimated-tax history, distribution readiness, reasonable-compensation evidence, basis status, and shareholder benefits. These are review/workpaper tasks, not everyday tax preparation. Capture Tracker does not file taxes or make tax conclusions.

At year-end

Open **Year-End Flight Check** and follow the sequence: Books, Owner Money, Payroll, Basis, Benefits, Fixed Assets, CPA Review Items, and CPA Package. Each section says **DONE**, **NEEDS YOU**, or **CPA REVIEW**.

The final bookkeeping state is **READY FOR CPA**, never "tax return ready." Then use the supported owner-only CPA access or package workflow.

Where common answers live

Question	Answer
What should I do today?	Read Today's Books Current Through status and primary next action.
How do I capture a receipt?	Today -> Add receipt, or + New -> Capture -> Add receipt.
How do I invoice someone?	Today -> Create invoice, or + New -> Money in.
How do I add a bill?	Today -> Add bill, or + New -> Money out.
How do I record mileage?	Today -> Record mileage, or + New -> Capture.
How do I know the books are current?	Read Books Current Through and its deterministic blocker.
What do I do weekly?	Run My Books.
What do I do monthly?	Reconcile and close the month.
Where do I see profit?	Reports -> Profit & Loss.
What is Owner Money?	Money -> You & the company -> Owner Money.
How do I prepare for my CPA?	Year-End Flight Check -> CPA access/package.

Finder remains an escape hatch for destinations such as invoice, mileage, CPA, and reconciliation. It searches curated product destinations, not customer financial data.

Safety boundaries

- Imported bank activity remains evidence until an owner confirms its accounting treatment.
- Uploaded documents remain private and unavailable until security validation succeeds.
- Reconciliation completes only at an exact **\$0.00** difference.
- Salary, distributions, reimbursements, contributions, shareholder loans, mileage, stock basis, debt basis, and benefits remain distinct.
- CPA access is read-only. CPA users receive no owner mutation controls in + New, Finder, or Run My Books.
- Capture Tracker does not file taxes, initiate payments, run payroll, or replace a CPA.

On phones, use Today / Money / Documents / Reports / More. Existing installed-iPhone pull-to-refresh behavior is unchanged.